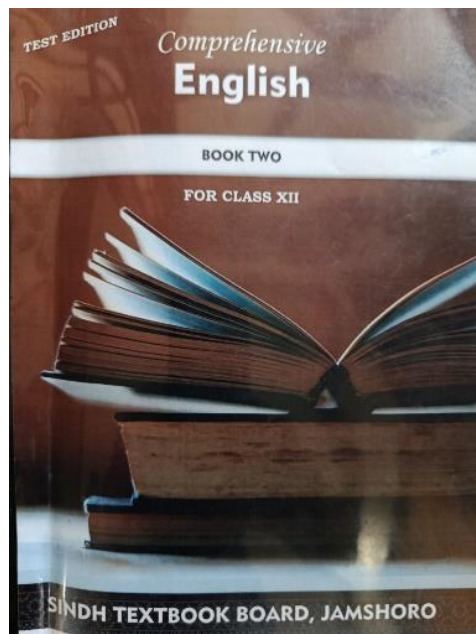


English
Book Two
For the class XII



How Much Land Does a Man Need?

By
Leo Tolstoy



Leo Tolstoy at a glance

Name	Leo Tolstoy
Born & died	1828 – 1910
Place of birth	Russia
Profession	A renowned Russian author, essayist, and philosopher
Literary period	Early Modern period
Notable works	War and Peace (1869) and Anna Karenina (1877)
Awards/Distinction	Considered almost a saint by followers of his moral philosophy
Main theme	The destructive, corrupting power of greed and insatiable ambition

About the Story

Type of Work	Moralistic fable
Written in	1886
Published in	1886
No. of Chapters	Seven (7) chapters or parts (Master story)
Setting (Place)	19th-century Rural Russia
Main Characters	The primary character is Pahom, a peasant farmer whose greed for land drives the narrative. Other key characters include the Devil (who tempts Pahom), the Bashkirs (who sell him land), and his wife.
Main Theme	The <u>corrupting nature of greed and insatiable ambition</u>

Short Question-Answers

Q-1 What moral lesson do you learn from the story of Pahom?

Ans- the story of Pahom teaches that uncontrolled greed ultimately leads to destruction. Pahom believes that owning more land will bring him security and happiness, but each new possession only increases his desire for more. His ambition blinds him to moderation and wisdom. In the end, he loses his life in pursuit of excess, and all he truly needs is six feet of earth for burial. The moral lesson is clear: contentment brings peace, while greed brings ruin.

Q-2 What urged Pahom to abandon his well-settled life and desire for more land?

Ans- Pahom abandons his well-settled life because of growing greed and dissatisfaction. Initially content as a peasant, he begins to believe that owning more land will free him from worries and give him complete security. Hearing others boast about landownership awakens envy and ambition in him. This desire gradually overpowers his contentment. Instead of appreciating what he has, Pahom becomes restless, constantly chasing more land, which ultimately leads to his tragic end.

Q-3 Describe what thoughts Pahom had about grasping the land?

Ans- Pahom becomes obsessed with the idea of grasping as much land as possible. When he hears the Bashkirs' offer, allowing him to own all the land he can encircle in a day, he is filled with excitement and ambition. He plans to walk a very wide circuit to secure the richest and most fertile plots. Instead of choosing a reasonable amount, he keeps extending his boundary, driven by greed. His thoughts focus only on gaining more, ignoring his physical limits and the risk involved.

Q-4 What strategy did Pahom use to mark the land that he covered while walking on it?

Ans- Pahom used a simple but risky strategy to mark the land. As he walked, he carried a spade and dug small holes at each turning point of his path. He placed pieces of turf in these holes so they could be clearly seen from a distance. His plan was to form a large circuit and return to the starting point by sunset. However, in trying to enclose too much land, he exhausted himself fatally.

Q. No-5- How did Pahom's attitude change, from being confident to fear of losing both life and land, as he went on in measuring the land?

Ans- Pahom begins the day with great confidence and excitement, certain that he will secure vast land. As he walks farther, his greed pushes him to widen the circle beyond reason. By afternoon, he realizes he has gone too far and panic replaces pride. The setting sun terrifies him; he fears losing both the land and his life. His confidence turns into desperation as he runs breathlessly toward the starting point.

Q. No-6 Do you think Pahom was pushing himself too hard while walking to cover as much land as possible? How?

Ans- Yes, in *How Much Land Does a Man Need?* by Leo Tolstoy, Pahom clearly pushes himself too hard. Instead of choosing a reasonable amount of land, he keeps extending his path to include more fertile areas. Even when he feels tired and the sun grows hotter, he refuses to turn back. His

greed overpowers his physical limits. By afternoon, he is exhausted, yet he forces himself to run to reach the starting point before sunset. This extreme strain ultimately costs him his life.

Q.No-7 Why was the Chief of Bashkirs laughing on Pahom's efforts?

Ans- The Chief of the Bashkirs laughs at Pahom because he understands the irony of the situation. The chief sees that Pahom's greed is driving him beyond his limits. While Pahom desperately runs to secure more land, the chief realizes that excessive desire may lead to his downfall. His laughter reflects both amusement and awareness that Pahom is exhausting himself foolishly. In the end, the chief's laughter becomes symbolic, as Pahom gains only enough land for his grave.

Q.No-8 What does the ending of the story reveal about Pahom's character?

Ans- The ending reveals that Pahom is ultimately consumed by greed. Despite several warnings and opportunities to remain content, he allows ambition to control his judgment. Even when exhausted, he risks his life to gain more land. His tragic death shows that he never learned the value of moderation. In the end, he needs only six feet of earth for burial, proving that his relentless desire for more brought him ruin instead of happiness.

A list of literary devices used in *How Much Land Does a Man Need?* by Leo Tolstoy, along with explanations:

1. Irony

- **Example:** Pahom dies trying to gain more land, only needing six feet of earth for burial.
- **Explanation:** The story's ending highlights situational irony, showing the contrast between Pahom's ambition and the simple reality of human needs.

2. Symbolism

- **Example:** Land represents human desire, greed, and the pursuit of material wealth.
- **Explanation:** Tolstoy uses land symbolically to show how excessive desire can consume a person and lead to moral and physical ruin.

3. Allegory / Fable

- **Example:** Pahom's story illustrates a moral lesson about greed and contentment.
- **Explanation:** The narrative is an allegorical tale where characters and events represent broader human traits and ethical lessons.

4. Hyperbole

- **Example:** Pahom's desire to own all the land he can walk around in a single day.

- **Explanation:** Exaggeration emphasizes his extreme greed and obsession, showing how it overwhelms reason.

. 5. Moral / Didactic Tone

- **Example:** The story's ending and repeated reflections on greed.
- **Explanation:** Tolstoy's narrative is explicitly designed to teach a lesson, showing the dangers of excessive ambition and the virtue of moderation.

6. Repetition

- **Example:** The recurring emphasis on "more land" and Pahom's repeated thoughts of greed.
- **Explanation:** Repetition reinforces Pahom's obsession, showing how desire dominates his thoughts.

7. Satire

- **Example:** The story lightly mocks human greed and the idea that more possessions bring happiness.
- **Explanation:** Through Pahom's folly, Tolstoy critiques society's materialism and the foolishness of human ambition.

Below are clear meanings and common synonyms for each word / phrase, written in simple, exam-friendly language:

1. Arable

Meaning: Suitable for growing crops; fit for cultivation.

Synonyms: cultivable, fertile, productive

2. Bruises

Meaning: Injuries causing discoloration of the skin without breaking it.

Synonyms: contusions, wounds, injuries

3. Cloak

Meaning: To cover or hide something.

Synonyms: conceal, disguise, mask

4. Damp hollow

Meaning: A low area of land that is slightly wet.

Synonyms: marshy depression, moist valley, wet dip

5. Dismount

Meaning: To get off a horse, bicycle, come down etc.

Synonyms: alight, descend, get down

6. Disperse

Meaning: To scatter in different directions.

Synonyms: scatter, spread, dissipate

7. Girdle

Meaning: To encircle or surround.

Synonyms: surround, encircle, belt

8. Glisten

Meaning: To shine softly with reflected light.

Synonyms: sparkle, shimmer, gleam

9. Hazy

Meaning: Not clear; slightly blurred.

Synonyms: misty, foggy, (unclear)

10. Hillock

Meaning: A small hill.

Synonyms: mound, knoll, rise

11. Homestead

Meaning: A house with surrounding land, especially a farmhouse.

Synonyms: farmhouse, estate, dwelling

12. In vain

Meaning: Without success or result.

Synonyms: unsuccessfully, fruitlessly, futilely

13. Kindle

Meaning: To start a fire or arouse a feeling.

Synonyms: ignite, spark, arouse

14. Longed

Meaning: Strongly desired.

Synonyms: yearned, craved, desired

15. Lopsided

Meaning: Uneven or unbalanced.

Synonyms: uneven, asymmetrical, unbalanced

16. Parched

Meaning: Extremely dry.

Synonyms: arid, dry, dehydrated

17. Pasture

Meaning: Land covered with grass for grazing animals.

Synonyms: meadow, grassland, grazing land

18. Pile up

Meaning: To accumulate or gather in large amounts.

Synonyms: accumulate, heap, amass

19. Quivering

Meaning: Shaking slightly and rapidly.

Synonyms: trembling, shaking, vibrating

20. Reckon it out

Meaning: To calculate or think something thoroughly.

Synonyms: calculate, figure out, determine

21. Rim

Meaning: The outer edge of something circular.

Synonyms: edge, border, brim

22. Rye

Meaning: A type of grain used for bread and animal feed.

Synonyms: cereal grain, barley (similar grain), wheat (related grain)

23. Scarcely

Meaning: Barely; hardly.

Synonyms: hardly, barely, rarely

24. Seize

Meaning: To take hold of suddenly or forcefully.

Synonyms: grab, grasp, capture

25. Sheaf

Meaning: A bundle of cut grain tied together.

Synonyms: bundle, stack, cluster

26. Soak

Meaning: To make thoroughly wet.

Synonyms: drench, saturate, steep

27. Steppe

Meaning: A large area of flat grassland without trees (especially in Eurasia).

Synonyms: plain, prairie, grassland

28. Stiffness

Meaning: Lack of flexibility or movement.

Synonyms: rigidity, inflexibility, tightness

29. Strain

Meaning: To stretch or put pressure on something; also, stress.

Synonyms: stress, tension, exertion

30. Tempting

Meaning: Attractive or inviting.

Synonyms: enticing, appealing, alluring

31. Turf

Meaning: The surface layer of grass and soil.

Synonyms: sod, grassland, lawn

32. Utter

Meaning: Complete; absolute OR to speak.

Synonyms: absolute, total, express

15 MCQs based on the essay “How Much Land Does a Man Need?”:

1. What first awakens Pahom’s desire for more land?

- A) A dream about wealth
- B) A quarrel between his wife and her sister
- C) Advice from a priest
- D) A government order

2. Pahom believes that if he had enough land, he would not fear:

- A) Poverty
- B) Illness

- C) The Devil
- D) Death

3. The Devil overhears Pahom's boast and decides to:

- A) Reward him
- B) Test and tempt him
- C) Warn him
- D) Ignore him

4. Why does Pahom move to another village?

- A) To escape debt
- B) To find better employment
- C) To obtain more land
- D) To join his relatives

5. The Bashkirs offer Pahom land on the condition that:

- A) He pays double price
- B) He works for them
- C) He marks the land he can walk around in one day
- D) He defeats them in a contest

6. What tool does Pahom carry while marking the land?

- A) A stick
- B) A rope
- C) A spade
- D) A flag

7. Why does Pahom continue walking farther instead of turning back early?

- A) He gets lost
- B) He wants to include more fertile land
- C) He fears the Bashkirs
- D) He is forced to continue

8. What time limit is given to Pahom?

- A) Until noon
- B) Until sunset
- C) Until sunrise
- D) Until midnight

9. What feeling replaces Pahom's confidence in the afternoon?

- A) Joy
- B) Pride
- C) Fear
- D) Anger

10. The Chief of the Bashkirs laughs because:

- A) Pahom looks foolish
- B) He understands Pahom's greed
- C) He plans to cheat him
- D) He dislikes strangers

11. What happens to Pahom at the end of the day?

- A) He becomes rich
- B) He loses the deal
- C) He faints and dies
- D) He returns safely home

12. How much land does Pahom finally need?

- A) Ten acres
- B) One field
- C) Six feet for his grave
- D) A thousand acres

13. The story mainly highlights the danger of:

- A) Laziness
- B) Pride
- C) Greed
- D) Ignorance

14. What is ironic about Pahom's death?

- A) He dies wealthy
- B) He dies without land
- C) He gains less land than he desired
- D) He is buried in a palace

15. The central moral of the story teaches that:

- A) Wealth ensures happiness
- B) Hard work always succeeds
- C) Contentment is better than greed
- D) Landownership brings respect

Answer Key with Justifications

1. Answer: B — A quarrel between his wife and her sister

The discussion about the advantages of town versus country life awakens Pahom's dissatisfaction. Hearing his sister-in-law boast about wealth makes him feel insecure and desirous of more land.

2. Answer: C — The Devil

Pahom boldly claims that if he had enough land, he would not even fear the Devil. This pride foreshadows his downfall.

3. Answer: B — Test and tempt him

The Devil overhears Pahom's statement and decides to tempt him through opportunities of landownership, gradually increasing his greed.

4. Answer: C — To obtain more land

Pahom moves from place to place because each time he thinks more land will bring him peace and prosperity.

5. Answer: C — He marks the land he can walk around in one day

The Bashkirs' unusual condition is that he may own as much land as he can encircle on foot in one day, provided he returns before sunset.

6. Answer: C — A spade

Pahom carries a spade to dig holes and place turf at turning points, marking the boundary of the land he claims.

7. Answer: B — He wants to include more fertile land

Instead of being content, Pahom keeps extending his path to secure richer and more valuable land, showing his greed.

8. Answer: B — Until sunset

He must return to the starting point before sunset; otherwise, he will lose the money and the land.

9. Answer: C — Fear

By afternoon, Pahom realizes he has gone too far. Fear replaces confidence as he worries about losing everything.

10. Answer: B — He understands Pahom's greed

The Chief laughs because he sees Pahom exhausting himself in his greed. He understands the irony of the situation.

11. Answer: C — He faints and dies

After running desperately to reach the starting point, Pahom collapses and dies from exhaustion.

12. Answer: C — Six feet for his grave

In the end, Pahom needs only six feet of land to be buried. This highlights the story's moral about human greed.

13. Answer: C — Greed

The central theme of the story is the destructive nature of greed and excessive ambition.

14. Answer: C — He gains less land than he desired

Ironically, despite striving for vast property, he ends up with only enough land for burial.

15. Answer: C — Contentment is better than greed

Tolstoy emphasizes that satisfaction with what one has leads to peace, while endless desire leads to destruction.

